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June 18, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HANDLE, FILE (ADJUSTABLE TYPE)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C., 20407, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers an adjustable-type handle for use with files or similar tools having tang-type shanks.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation to bid, or request for proposals, form a part of this specification:

Federal Standards:
Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:
MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools, Packaging of.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 5110

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal shall apply:

National Bureau of Standards Handbook:
H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components and design. The handle shall consist of a body containing jaws or chuck, and an actuating mechanism for securely gripping and holding the jaws during filing operation. It shall be shaped and proportioned to provide a comfortable handgrip.

3.2 Material. The handle may be of wood and metal construction, or formed entirely from metal.

3.2.1 Wood and metal. Handle may be of hardwood or any other wood normally used for file handles. Jaws, ferrule and adjusting mechanism shall be of steel. Moisture content of the wood shall not exceed 15 percent.

3.2.1.1 Ferrule. Handles made of wood shall have a steel ferrule of not less than 22 gage, securely impressed around the jaw end of the handle to prevent splitting of the wood.

3.2.2 Metal. Handle may be of aluminum or other metal of sufficient strength and durability for the duty to be performed. The hand-holding portion of the handle shall be knurled or serrated to facilitate gripping during filing operations.

3.3 Jaws or chuck. The handle shall be fitted with tang-holding jaws or chuck extending axially into the handle body for a sufficient depth to provide adequate support and grip of the file during filing operation. The jaws shall be properly hardened to prevent deformation and wear under normal service conditions. Gripping surfaces may be notched or serrated to assure holding the file securely.

3.4 Adjusting mechanism. The adjusting mechanism shall consist of a threaded metal sleeve or screw, and adjusting cap, which by tightening will exert the require pressure on the jaws and securely grip the file during filing operations. Screw threads shall be in accordance with applicable requirements of National Bureau of Standards Handbook H28. The lengthwise movement of the adjusting mechanism shall cause contraction or expansion of the gripping portion of the jaws.

3.5 Dimensions. With tang-holding device or jaws retracted into handle to lowest position, the handle shall have a nominal overall length of 4-1/8 inches and a minimum diameter of 1 inch at the largest portion of the body.

3.6 Finish.

3.6.1 Wood and metal handles. Handles shall be smoothly finished. No cracks or splinters shall be visible. All metal portions shall be free from burrs and sharp edges.

3.6.2 Metal handles. Except for the knurled or serrated portions, the handle shall be smoothly polished. All burrs and sharp edges shall be removed.

3.7 Identification marking. Each handle shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class in every respect.

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4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. A lot shall consist of handles fabricated under the same process and control. A sample unit shall be one handle.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual examination. Sampling for visual examination shall have an inspection level of II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per 100 units.

4.2.3 Sampling for dimensional examination. The inspection level for dimensional examination shall be level S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 defects per 100 units.

4.3 Inspection of handles.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Each sample handle shall be visually examined for defects in material and workmanship. Any deviation from requirements specified herein shall be considered a defect.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. Each sample handle shall be examined for conformance with dimensional requirements specified herein. Any deviation shall be considered a defect.

4.4 Test procedure.

4.4.1 Performance. A file with tang of conventional size and shape shall be fitted into the handle. Trial filing operation shall be conducted on steel surfaces to determine if the file is securely gripped and maintains the grip throughout the test. Examination shall be made to ascertain that the handle meets the requirements of 3.3 and 3.4.

4.5 Moisture content. Each of the sample wood handles shall be tested to verify compliance with the moisture content requirement of 3.2.1. An electrical moisture meter or other equally suitable method shall be used to determine moisture content. Any handle in the sample having moisture content in excess of 15 percent shall be rejected.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery requirements shall be accomplished in accordance with MIL-H-15424.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY
(Civil agencies should refer to Fed. Std. No. 102 for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 Level A. File handles shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.2 Level C. Preservation and packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. (vendor to user)

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5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.2 Level B. Level B packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 Level C. Packing which will afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.1), shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.1), interior and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Levels of preservation, packaging and packing required (see section 5).
(c) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

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